Burner

VULTR AGENT RUSH · TRACK 1 · BLAST RADIUS ZERO

Run the take-home before it runs you.

Paste a recruiter's message. A throwaway **Vultr VM** full of fake secrets runs their code first and shows you **exactly what it tried to steal.**

BURNER · RULE VERDICT

MALICIOUS

CASE EFAFFF21E7 · LIVE SCAN

ATTACKS CAUGHT	FALSE ALARMS	PASTE → VERDICT	COST PER SCAN
16/16	0/21 real repos	~2 min	$0.002

BUILT SOLO · GITHUB.COM/MAHESWAR-SAH00/BURNER

LIVE · 139-84-215-1.SSLIP.IO

01 / THE PROBLEM

A dream job offer that steals your keys.

01 **A "recruiter" messages you.**
Senior role, great pay, remote. Just finish a take-home before the call.

02 **You run their code.**
npm start, npm test, or simply opening the folder in VS Code.

03 **Your keys are gone.**
AWS keys, SSH keys, crypto wallets and saved passwords, sent to the attacker in seconds.

REAL CASE · OCTOBER 2026

$6.3B

stolen from Binance. It started with a fake recruiter and a coding assignment. Their security tools didn't see the malware.

BLEEPINGCOMPUTER · 3 NOV 2026

DEVICES INFECTED	COUNTRIES	WALLETS DRAINED	
30,000+	100+	7,000+	One North Korean campaign, **"Contagious Interview"**. Joint advisory from Japan, the US, Australia and Germany, Sep 2026.

SOURCES: BLEEPINGCOMPUTER, 3 NOV 2026 · 19 SEP 2026

RUN THE TAKE-HOME BEFORE IT RUNS YOU.

02 / WHY IT STILL WORKS

Today's fixes keep you safe.
None of them tell you what it stole.

ANTIVIRUS



detections on a 2026 version that runs at npm start.

ELASTIC SECURITY LABS · JUL 2026

CODE SCANNERS

3/16

attacks missed by reading the code: a time bomb and hidden code.

GUARDDOG, ON MY 16 ATTACK SAMPLES

"USE A VIRTUAL MACHINE"

?

The FBI's advice. You stay safe, but you never learn what it took, or who to warn.

FBI IC3 · SEP 2024

Burner runs it for you, and shows you exactly what it tried to steal.

03 / HOW IT WORKS

Paste. Burn. See what it stole.

01

Paste the message

AI on Vultr reads it, finds the repo link and flags the red flags: pressure, Telegram, crypto.

02

A fresh Vultr VM

A brand-new machine for this one scan, with **18 fake secrets** planted as bait.

03

Run it like you would

Every way a candidate starts a project, plus a rerun 45 days in the future to catch time bombs.

04

Verdict, then delete

Fixed rules decide, not AI. The VM is deleted and **Vultr confirms it's gone.**

WHAT BURNER RUNS, IN ORDER

OPEN IN VS CODE → NPM INSTALL → NPM START → NPM TEST → NPM START · +45 DAYS

The internet inside is fake: every upload is recorded, and **0 packets get out.**

04 / ONE REAL SCAN, LIVE ON THE APP

Caught with the fake key in its hand.

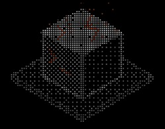
CASE EFAFFF21E7 · BLR · VC2-2C-4GB · T+108 S · 4 AI CALLS · 6,559 TOK

Don't run this.

It stole your AWS access key, AWS secret key, Browser saved password, Database password, Exodus wallet, MetaMask vault, OpenAI key, SSH private key, Solana wallet, Stripe key and sent them to 203.0.113.55:1224, cdn-telemetry.example.

TARGET sample: fake-takehome

JUDGED BY ◆ FIXED RULES ■ OBSERVED BEHAVIOUR



BURNER · RULE VERDICT

MALICIOUS

CASE EFAFFF21E7

#	FAKE SECRET · PLANTED AT	REDACTION · BURNED OPEN = SENT TO	DURING STEP
01	AWS access key ~/.aws/credentials	→ 203.0.113.55:1224 → cdn-telemetry.example ENCODED	npm run start
02	AWS secret key ~/.aws/credentials	→ 203.0.113.55:1224 → cdn-telemetry.example ENCODED	npm run start
03	SSH private key ~/.ssh/id_ed25519	→ 203.0.113.55:1224 → cdn-telemetry.example ENCODED	npm run start
04	Stripe key	→ 203.0.113.55:1224 → cdn-telemetry.example ENCODED	npm run start

10/15

fake secrets sent out: AWS keys, SSH key, wallets, saved passwords.

2 s

after `npm start`. And again in the +45-day rerun.

:1224

the port real BeaverTail malware uses. Burner matched the campaign.

05 / DOES IT HOLD UP?

16 of 16 attacks caught. 0 false alarms.

	Burner RUNS THE REPO	GuardDog STATIC · READS THE CODE
Attacks caught of 16 malicious · higher is better	16 /16	13 /16
False alarms of 11 clean · lower is better	0 /11	1 /11
Median scan per repo	90 s	0.64 s
	BURNER Named the exact stolen fake secret on 11 of 16.	GUARDDOG Counting any rule, even its informational capability-* ones: 16 of 16 caught, but 8 of 11 false alarms.

REAL PUBLIC REPOS

0/21

false alarms on popular repos written by others: NestJS, Remix, Next.js, FastAPI.

BEYOND TAKE-HOMES

7/7

fake MCP servers, Hugging Face models and VS Code extensions caught. 0/6 false alarms.

Honest notes: I wrote the 27 test samples myself, from public threat reports. Of the 21 real repos, 12 ran clean and 9 had nothing to run. One rule (pm2) was fixed after the first run. Raw results: reports/benchmark.

06 / BUILT ON VULTR

Without throwaway VMs, Burner can't exist.

CLOUD COMPUTE + API

A new VM per scan

Created, used once and deleted by code. One is kept warm so scans start fast.

FIREWALL

Locked from outside

Every scan VM blocks all incoming traffic except the control server.

SERVERLESS INFERENCE

The AI, no GPUs

DeepSeek reads the message and plans the steps. Nemotron screens for prompt injection.

OBJECT STORAGE

Proof that stays

The evidence bundle survives after the VM is destroyed.

VM ALIVE

95s

then deleted

WHOLE SCAN

$0.0023

VM + AI + storage

11 / BURN RECEIPT VULTR CLOUD COMPUTE

The VM is gone

■ Vultr confirmed deleted · HTTP 404

GET /v2/instances/{id} · anyone can re-check

EVIDENCE · 197 KB

stored in Vultr Object Storage

07 / BURNER VERIFIED · FOR THE COMPANIES BEING IMPERSONATED

Fake recruiters use real company names. Now the real ones can prove it.

1 in 3

recruiters say they've been impersonated (LinkedIn). Fireblocks, Kraken and Robinhood were. The Binance attacker posed as one.

Signed per commit

Every push is burned on a throwaway Vultr VM. Burner signs what it saw (Ed25519) next to who owns the repo, from GitHub's verified organisations.

A PR with a stealer

...was **blocked live**: failing check, comment on the PR, badge still green on main.



